CELPIP EXPRESS

Reading Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 11

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

Read the following message.

Dear Mr. Meyer,

I am writing about the new driving restrictions your government department is suggesting for new drivers in the province. I definitely agree that certain restrictions are necessary to ensure road safety. However, I disagree with one major point.

Your department is proposing a "single passenger" restriction that allows a novice driver to have one passenger, unless the passengers are immediate family members. Your logic is simply that novice drivers are usually teenagers, and a car full of teenagers is distracting to the driver. You state that this rule has done much to reduce the incidence of crashes in other provinces.

There is simply no conclusive evidence to support this claim. In fact, there's a major reason why the "one-passenger" rule might actually lead to more accidents on the road. Take for example a situation that happened last Saturday. My 16-year-old son, John, who recently got his novice driver's license, needed to work on a school project with five of his classmates. They were making a short film for their history class, which required them to drive around the city visiting various museums. John has use of my van, which seats six people. Under the current law, he can drive his friends. He is a safe driver and no accidents happened. Under the proposed restriction, John would be legally allowed to drive only one passenger. His friends, who are also new drivers, would then have to take two other vehicles. Therefore, the "one-passenger" rule would actually triple the possibility of a crash by requiring the use of three cars, when only one was needed! Where's the safety in that?

Because most novice drivers are teenagers, the proposal for the "one-passenger" rule will lead to more inexperienced teenage drivers being on the road at one time. Where two or three teenagers are following each other in separate cars, they may act foolishly by driving too fast or passing dangerously. I recognize the good intention behind your proposal, but I wonder if it will actually be effective.

Sincerely,

James Brandt

Choose the **best** option according to the information given in the message.

1. James Brandt is a _____
- ◯ teenage driver.
- ◯ driving instructor.
- ◯ new driver's parent.
- ◯ novice driver.

2. The proposed rule will prohibit new drivers from carrying _____
- ◯ more than one non-family passenger.
- ◯ teenagers as passengers.
- ◯ non-family members as passengers.
- ◯ other new drivers as passengers.

3. According to James, the proposed rule _____
- ◯ may reduce accidents by new drivers.
- ◯ is based on a careful study of the facts.
- ◯ is unfair for the parents of new drivers.
- ◯ may increase the risk of accidents.

4. If the proposed rule becomes law, John _____
- ◯ can't drive his 5 classmates.
- ◯ can drive a van with 5 passengers.
- ◯ can drive without his parent's knowledge.
- ◯ can't drive his family members.

5. John _____
- ◯ acted irresponsibly with his passengers.
- ◯ didn't take any passengers.
- ◯ knows his responsibilities as a driver.
- ◯ was pressured to drive foolishly and dangerously.

6. James Brandt believes the proposed rule _____
- ◯ might stop new drivers from practicing.
- ◯ will put more new drivers on the road.
- ◯ may prevent young people from getting around.
- ◯ will make parents of new drivers more responsible.

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

Here is a response to the message. Complete the response by filling in the blanks.

Dear Mr. Brandt,

On behalf of Gerry Meyer, I would like to thank you for
7. _____ You argued that the "single passenger" restriction 8. _____

We understand your concerns. In fact, we initially shared
your concerns about this issue. However, research has shown us that our proposed rule will work. We found that the highest risk of accidents occurs when young drivers are driving 9. _____ In addition, research shows that parents often discourage their teenagers from driving with their friends, so the proposed rule actually 10. _____ majority opinion.

Clearly, we both 11._____

Respectfully yours,
Mariel Singh

7. ◯ sharing your opinions.
◯ supporting our policies.
◯ explaining the rules to your son.
◯ suggesting the "single passenger" rule.

8. ◯ will stop young drivers from helping their families.
◯ is a very good way to increase road safety.
◯ may increase the risk of accident and injury.
◯ will teach young drivers to be more responsible.

9. ◯ in separate cars.
◯ family members.
◯ their parents.
◯ several teenagers.

10. ◯ disagrees with
◯ supports
◯ results from
◯ contradicts

11. ◯ agree with the new proposal.
◯ care about the safety of young drivers.
◯ have concerns about the new proposal.
◯ disagree with Mr. Brandt's ideas.

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PART 2

Thurs., July 12	Fri., July 13	Sat., July 14	Sun., July 15
8:30 Wake Up	8:30 Wake Up	8:30 Wake Up	8:30 Wake Up
9:00 Breakfast	9:00 Breakfast	9:00 Breakfast	9:00 Breakfast
9:35 - 10:45 English Lesson I	9:35 - 10:15 English Lesson I	9:35 - 10:45 English Lesson I	9:35 - 10:45 English Lesson I
10:45 - 11:55 English Lesson II	10:15 - 11:00 English Lesson II	10:45 - 11:55 English Lesson II	10:45 - 11:55 English Lesson II
12:00 Lunch	11:00 - 11:45 English Lesson III	12:00 Lunch	12:00 Lunch
1:00 - 2:10 English Lesson III	11:45 Lunch	1:00 - 2:10 English Lesson III	1:00 - 2:10 English Lesson III
2:30 Vancouver Aquarium Marine Science Centre		3:00 Rock Climbing	2:30 Museum of Anthropology & Botanical Garden at UBZ
	12:15 Leave for Full Day Excursion		
4:00 Vancouver Harbour Centre	West Coast Rainforest	7:00 Supper	7:00 Supper
		8:00 Talent Night: A Spoof of Reality Shows	
6:30 Supper	7:00 Supper		8:00 Pack and get ready for the camping trip
7:00 Games and Tent Practice Night	9:00 Return to campus residence		

Read the following email message about the diagram on the left. Complete the email by filling in the blanks

Subject: English as a Second Language Summer Camp
To: Ray Carly <r.carly@ubz.ca>
From: Aries Singler <a.singler@ubz.ca>

Hi Ray,

Sarah and I met this morning to finalize the Summer Camp schedule but we need your input before we make it official, and inform the teachers about their 1. _____ Last year, a couple of teachers had to rush through the material, do you think that 2. _____ would resolve the problem?

You will see that this year 3. _____ I dedicated the afternoons for sightseeing instead. How do you feel about that?

Also, neither of us knows whether we are providing all meals or just breakfast and supper like last year. We only know that the 4. _____ are included in the tuition under social activities. Finally, we need to make a final decision about 5. _____ the campsite after the ferry ride to Victoria Island. Sarah suggested we charter a bus to pick us up at the ferry station but I thought this year's campsite was only accessible by boat.

Please let us know,

Aries

1. ◯ class times.
   ◯ students' names.
   ◯ schedule changes.
   ◯ work benefits.

2. ◯ allowing students to get more sleep in the morning
   ◯ giving students opportunities to socialize outside campus
   ◯ making the material more appealing for teachers
   ◯ starting the day at 9 a.m. instead of 9:35 a.m.

3. ◯ there is only one social activity per day.
   ◯ all classes are concentrated before lunch.
   ◯ there are no social activities in the morning.
   ◯ students will not leave the campus everyday.

4. ◯ outings
   ◯ lessons
   ◯ books
   ◯ accommodation

5. ◯ who's chaperoning the students to
   ◯ the transportation to and from
   ◯ how long we'll be staying at
   ◯ the facilities we'll have access to at

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 2

Choose the best option.

6. Aries is emailing Ray _____

- ◯ to make a complaint.
- ◯ to ask for advice.
- ◯ to request changes.
- ◯ to relieve him of duties.

7. Last year's camp _____

- ◯ did not take students on a camping trip.
- ◯ provided students with all meals.
- ◯ focused exclusively on academic activities.
- ◯ featured social activities in the morning.

8. Aries _____

- ◯ needs Ray to authorize the proposal before presenting it to the teachers.
- ◯ created the schedule for this year's camp all by herself.
- ◯ will be joining the students on the camping trip.
- ◯ hasn't made any changes to the previous schedule.

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

A. Anyone who has ever lived in a city or suburb has likely encountered crows. Over 31 species can be found worldwide, with the exception of South America and Antarctica. Historically, these creatures were synonymous with death and the afterlife in many cultures. Nowadays, most people regard crows as a nuisance since they are loud and messy, especially in large groups. Recent research, however, has revealed that these birds are actually far more remarkable than previously thought. In fact, crow behavior has striking similarities to that of humans.

B. Like people, crows are highly social creatures. Their lives revolve around the family. Crow families generally consist of two parents and anywhere from two to fifteen offspring, though the average family size is four. Most species of crows do not breed until approximately four years old, and only about half of their offspring survive the first year of life. During the phase prior to reproduction, young crows help their parents rear their siblings. Groups of crows, often referred to as a "murder," also cooperate to guard their territory from predators.

C. Although classified as songbirds, crows lack melodic voices. Their call is often perceived as a coarse "caw" to the human ear. Nonetheless, these creatures have an intricate communication system consisting of over 250 distinct cries that convey a variety of messages such as alarm, feeding, assembly, and fighting. Their language comprises two dialects, one for interacting with neighbouring crows and another quieter dialect reserved for relatives. Crows are also able to imitate the sounds of other species, including some elements of human speech. Because crows in different geographical areas may not use or comprehend the same calls, it makes deciphering the language difficult for researchers.

D. Scientists have only recently begun studying crows and have been astonished by the extent of their intelligence. One study has revealed that crows can both use and make tools. This is a significant discovery as only two other species of animals can do so— elephants and chimpanzees. In another study, crows discovered and taught others how to get nuts from a vending machine by inserting coins that were scattered on the ground. Crows are also very adaptable creatures that thrive in cities. In Tokyo, where many people hang their laundry outside to dry, crows gather metal hangers to build nests since they are more readily available than the proper size twigs. Scientists now realize that crows have the intellectual capacity to plan, solve problems, and teach new behaviours to others.

E. Not given in any of the above paragraphs.

1. Crows have demonstrated construction skills that are rare among animals.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

2. The life expectancy of crows is approximately 15 years.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

3. Crows can copy the tones made by other beings.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

4. Crows manage particularly well in urban environments.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

5. Crows have demonstrated the ability to creatively overcome challenges.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

6. Young crows assist in raising the offspring of neighbours.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

7. At least one variety of crows exists in most continents.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

8. Different voices are used by crows for different social connections.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

9. Crows work collaboratively to protect each other from threats.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 4

Read the following article from a website.

BC's Annual School Report released today has officials, teachers, parents, and students lined up on both sides of the debate over province-wide standardized testing of grade 4 and 7 students. No one was surprised to hear students slander the five-hour battery of reading, writing, and math exams, but most interviewed parents supported the yearly assessment, whose results are used to publicly rank schools based on students' overall scores. Sophie Bloom, mother of a Whitesands Elementary School kindergartener, applauds the test—and heeds the rankings. "As a taxpayer and parent, I expect access to this kind of information. I want my child at the top school. Whitesands doesn't measure up. I'm considering Oceanview."

Oceanview School principal Christine Shelley admits she has mixed feelings about compelling teachers to administer the provincially mandated tests but agrees parents have every right to expect statistics on school outcomes, provided they don't use them to unfairly compare public and private schools. "Standardized tests hold teachers and schools appropriately answerable to their stakeholders. Without statistics on learning outcomes, how could we ensure schools are doing what they're publicly funded and mandated to do?"

Adam Birch, who teaches Grade Four at Forestgrove Elementary, is skeptical of the assessments but grudgingly complies. "Standardized testing reinforces the social myth that if we're not competing, we're unproductive," says Birch. "It overlooks many forms of intelligence and mostly rewards test-taking ability. Many gifted students fail these tests. And the tests are like a snapshot; they tell us nothing about a student's improvement."

At Valleyside Middle School, grade seven teacher Gilles Legault is on the brink of mutiny. "Every classroom hour I spend on 'test prep' is one hour stolen from an actually beneficial learning activity." Legault, whose school outperformed both Oceanview and Forestgrove, concedes the tests provide relevant comparative data but thinks such comparisons merely confirm what we already know: schools in affluent neighborhoods do better. "For this common knowledge," Legault says, "standardized testing squanders 15 million dollars of provincial funds annually. Instead, why not hire more teachers, reduce class sizes, improve services?"

Choose the **best** option according to the information given on the website.

1. Birch says that standardized testing _____
- ◯ makes schools less productive.
- ◯ doesn't measure student progress.
- ◯ undermines healthy competition.
- ◯ overlooks genuine intelligence.

2. Bloom would be most satisfied with _____
- ◯ Forestgrove.
- ◯ Oceanview.
- ◯ Valleyside.
- ◯ Whitesands.

3. Legault and Shelley agree standardized testing offers an opportunity to _____
- ◯ gather statistical data.
- ◯ improve study skills.
- ◯ negotiate class sizes.
- ◯ clarify school mandates.

4. Both teachers would be happier if the scope of standardized testing was _____
- ◯ much broader.
- ◯ more limited.
- ◯ applied to public schools only.
- ◯ used to intensify competition.

5. Overall, the article implies that standardized testing is _____
- ◯ outdated.
- ◯ jeopardized.
- ◯ invaluable.
- ◯ divisive.

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 4

The following is a comment by a visitor to the website page. Complete the comment by choosing the best option to fill in each blank.

While I have genuine sympathy for the teachers' opinions, I hope none chooses to 6. _____ their boss's orders anytime soon. School teachers may be right in saying
that standardized testing is 7. _____ but as long as they are collecting salaries, they need to follow the procedures set out in their job descriptions. After all, as was implied in the article, school teachers are civil servants answerable to 8. _____ stakeholders. The issue of whether or not these stakeholders' agendas have children's best interests at heart was 9. _____ in Legault's comments. But that's a separate issue. The way to stop standardized testing in schools, if that's what is wanted, is to remove from power the 10. _____ that mandate them.

6. ◯ defy
   ◯ accept
   ◯ mock
   ◯ forget

7. ◯ outdated and inefficient,
   ◯ gaining in popularity,
   ◯ of limited value,
   ◯ targeting private schools,

8. ◯ public
   ◯ provincial
   ◯ powerful
   ◯ community

9. ◯ glossed over
   ◯ touched on
   ◯ brushed off
   ◯ pointed out

10. ◯ provincial governments
    ◯ boards of education
    ◯ parent committees
    ◯ school principals

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	new driver's parent.
Question 2	more than one non-family passenger.
Question 3	may increase the risk of accidents.
Question 4	can't drive his 5 classmates.
Question 5	knows his responsibilities as a driver.
Question 6	will put more new drivers on the road.
Question 7	sharing your opinions.
Question 8	may increase the risk of accident and injury.
Question 9	several teenagers.
Question 10	supports
Question 11	care about the safety of young drivers.

PART 2	
Question 1	class times.
Question 2	starting the day at 9 a.m. instead of 9:35 a.m.
Question 3	there are no social activities in the morning.
Question 4	outings
Question 5	the transportation to and from
Question 6	to ask for advice.
Question 7	featured social activities in the morning.
Question 8	will be joining the students on the camping trip.

PART 3	
Question 1	D
Question 2	E
Question 3	C
Question 4	D
Question 5	D
Question 6	E
Question 7	A
Question 8	C
Question 9	B

PART 4	
Question 1	doesn't measure student progress.
Question 2	Valleyside.
Question 3	gather statistical data.
Question 4	more limited.
Question 5	divisive.
Question 6	defy
Question 7	of limited value,
Question 8	public
Question 9	touched on
Question 10	provincial governments

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -